

2026 U.S. **ANIMAL KILL CLOCK**

42,319,374,132

animals have been killed for food
this year in the United States


 (http://www.facebook.com/intent/tweet?text=42,319,374,132%20animals+are+bred+for+slaughter+on+factory+farms+in+the+US&u=http://www.vegetarian.org.uk/2016/01/20/animal-death-statistics-are-a-horror-story/)




ANNUAL U.S. ANIMAL DEATH STATS



CHICKENS
8,127,632,113



TURKEYS
214,508,816



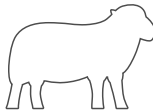
CATTLE
36,163,973



PIGS
124,061,094



DUCKS
23,275,362



SHEEP
7,499,676



FISH¹
3,797,000,000



SHELLFISH¹
43,109,000,000

“The question is not, can they reason? Nor, can they talk? But, can they suffer?”
– Jeremy Bentham, Philosopher, 1789

~1.7m rabbits are killed annually (https://www.aphis.usda.gov/animal_health/emergingissues/downloads/RabbitReport1.pdf) (USDA). Photo courtesy Animal Equality (<http://www.animalequality.net/news/623/new-undercover-investigation-reveals-cruelty-inside-rabbit-farms-linked-uk>).

BY THE NUMBERS

10,548

Number of animals killed for food in the U.S. since you visited this page.

1,800 gallons

(6,800 liters)

Amount of water used to produce one pound of beef. Equivalent to 7 years of drinking water for the average person.

Ecosystems. 2002 (<https://wfn.project-platforms.com/Reports/Mekonnen-Hoekstra-2012-WaterFootprintFarmAnimalProducts.pdf>).

8 by 10 inches

(20 × 25 cm)

Amount of space in which battery caged egg-laying hens spend their entire lives, unable to spread their wings.

Guidelines For U.S. Egg Laying Flocks. 2016. (<https://uepcertified.com/wp-content/uploads/2015/08/UEP-Animal-Welfare-Guidelines-20141.pdf>).

825,000

Number of chickens (<https://link.springer.com/article/10.1007/s10071-016-1064-4>) accidentally boiled and drowned alive during slaughter every year in the U.S.

USDA. Reported by Washington Post. 2013 (https://www.washingtonpost.com/politics/usda-plan-to-speed-up-poultry-processing-lines-could-increase-risk-of-bird-abuse/2013/10/29/aeef1e-3b2e-11e3-b6a9-da62c264f40e_story.html).

2 by 6.6 feet

(60 cm × 2 meters)

Average size of a gestation crate in which breeding pigs spend most of their adult life.

Humane Society of the U.S. 2008 (<https://web.archive.org/web/20100703144502/http://www.hsus.org/web-files/PDF/farm/HSUS-Report-on-Gestation-Crates-for-Pregnant-Sows.pdf>).

26.2%

(21.7% by consumers)

Percent of U.S. retail meat discarded by stores and consumers. This staggering number equates to 14 billion animals.

Counting Animals. 2013 (<https://www.countinganimals.com/animals-we-use-and-abuse-for-food-we-do-not-eat/>).

41%

Percent of U.S. land in the 48 contiguous states used for livestock pastures/range (33%) and animal feed production (8%).

USDA ERS Major Land Uses. 2017 (<https://www.ers.usda.gov/data-products/major-land-uses.aspx>), Bloomberg Visualization (<https://www.bloomberg.com/graphics/2018-us-land-use/>).

“The American industrial animal farm offers a nightmarish glimpse of what capitalism can look like in the absence of moral or regulatory constraint.”

– Michael Pollan, *An Animal's Place*, 2002



YOU CAN MAKE A DIFFERENCE

The following organizations are making a difference through undercover investigations, public education, and legal advocacy. Visit their sites to learn how you can make a difference.



Visit (<https://www.facebook.com/AnimalEquality/>)



Visit (<https://www.facebook.com/mercyforanimals/>)



Visit (<https://www.facebook.com/CompassionUSA/>)



Visit (<https://www.facebook.com/thehumaneleague/>)

QUESTIONS AND ANSWERS

Billions of intelligent animals, capable of feeling fear and pain, suffer in the dark without sympathy or compassion at a scale that is hard to imagine.

Do animals feel pain?

The desire to survive is a basic evolutionary precept not exclusive to humans. Pain is both a critical indicator of injury or illness as well as a strong motivator to avoid actions that lead to (or prolong) injury or illness. While there is no reason to assume non-human animals don't feel pain, the scientific community has explored (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Wild_animal_suffering), and debunked (<http://news.nationalgeographic.com/2016/12/animals-science-medical-pain/>), the myth many times over. Cows, chickens (<https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pubmed/10766114>), and many crustaceans (https://en.wikipedia.org/wiki/Pain_in_crustaceans) and fish (<https://www.humanesociety.org/sites/default/files/docs/fish-and-pain-perception.pdf>) feel (<https://www.smithsonianmag.com/science-nature/fish-feel-pain-180967764/>), pain (<http://jeb.biologists.org/content/jebio/218/7/967.full.pdf>).

Do animals fear their death?

Yes. Many of the animals we eat are highly intelligent creatures capable of feeling fear and empathy.

Numerous [scientific studies \(https://animalstudiesrepository.org/acwp_asie/\)](https://animalstudiesrepository.org/acwp_asie/) demonstrate that the animals we eat fear for their own wellbeing. Animals including [fish \(http://animalstudiesrepository.org/cgi/viewcontent.cgi?article=1074&context=acwp_asie\)](http://animalstudiesrepository.org/cgi/viewcontent.cgi?article=1074&context=acwp_asie), [rats \(http://www.animalcognition.org/2015/06/16/rat-empathy/\)](http://www.animalcognition.org/2015/06/16/rat-empathy/), and mice [defend \(http://www.dailymail.co.uk/news/article-2397070/\)](http://www.dailymail.co.uk/news/article-2397070/) and even mourn the loss of their family and friends.

Until recently, most people were unaware that pigs are as smart as dogs. Pigs [use tools \(http://www.huffingtonpost.com/ingrid-newkirk/9-ways-pigs-are-smarter-t_b_5154321.html\)](http://www.huffingtonpost.com/ingrid-newkirk/9-ways-pigs-are-smarter-t_b_5154321.html), [understand symbolic language \(http://animalstudiesrepository.org/cgi/viewcontent.cgi?article=1042&context=acwp_asie\)](http://animalstudiesrepository.org/cgi/viewcontent.cgi?article=1042&context=acwp_asie) and [mirrors \(https://www.nytimes.com/2009/11/10/science/10angier.html\)](https://www.nytimes.com/2009/11/10/science/10angier.html), [can be house trained \(https://www.wikihow.com/House-Train-a-Pig\)](https://www.wikihow.com/House-Train-a-Pig), [wag their tails when happy \(http://pigspeace.org/main/didyouknow.html\)](http://pigspeace.org/main/didyouknow.html), [control their environment \(https://news.google.com/newspapers?nid=1946&dat=19830827&id=SpEjAAAAIAJ&sjid=R6UFAAAAIAJ&pg=6043,2564179\)](https://news.google.com/newspapers?nid=1946&dat=19830827&id=SpEjAAAAIAJ&sjid=R6UFAAAAIAJ&pg=6043,2564179), and are [empathetic \(https://blogs.scientificamerican.com/not-bad-science/can-pigs-empathize/\)](https://blogs.scientificamerican.com/not-bad-science/can-pigs-empathize/). Even less intelligent animals like [chickens \(http://rspb.royalsocietypublishing.org/content/278/1721/3129\)](https://rspb.royalsocietypublishing.org/content/278/1721/3129), [rats \(https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC3760221/\)](https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC3760221/) and [mice \(http://daniellevitin.com/levitinlab/articles/2006-Langford-Science.pdf\)](http://daniellevitin.com/levitinlab/articles/2006-Langford-Science.pdf) demonstrate [empathy \(https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC3183383/\)](https://www.ncbi.nlm.nih.gov/pmc/articles/PMC3183383/).

I like eating meat. Can I still help?

If you're not ready to go vegan, you can still save animals without dramatically changing your diet. Here are a few completely effortless ways that you can make a big difference:

- At the grocery store, purchase only the amount of meat that your family is certain to eat. American consumers throw away [21.7% \(http://www.countinganimals.com/animals-we-use-and-abuse-for-food-we-do-not-eat/\)](http://www.countinganimals.com/animals-we-use-and-abuse-for-food-we-do-not-eat/) of the meat they purchase—needlessly killing billions of animals.
- Opt for products from animals that haven't been tortured. When purchasing meat, egg, or dairy products, look for obvious [animal welfare labeling \(https://www.aspc.org/take-action/help-farm-animals/meat-eggs-dairy-label-guide\)](https://www.aspc.org/take-action/help-farm-animals/meat-eggs-dairy-label-guide) on the packaging. And *never* eat [veal \(https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Jgy1M9teRwU\)](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=Jgy1M9teRwU) or [foie gras \(https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DyOu-GVtgPQ\)](https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=DyOu-GVtgPQ).
- Eliminate one animal product from one meal each day (e.g. drop the sausage at breakfast, grilled chicken from your salad, or bacon from your club sandwich).
- Offset your animal cruelty footprint by donating to a [highly rated animal welfare charity \(https://animalcharityevaluators.org/charity-reviews/all-charity-reviews/\)](https://animalcharityevaluators.org/charity-reviews/all-charity-reviews/). These organizations uncover animal abuse and advocate for the humane treatment of the animals you eat.
- Explore animal-free [dietary options \(https://thegreenplate.com/\)](https://thegreenplate.com/). There are amazing new cruelty-free [substitutes \(https://veganoutreach.org/subs/\)](https://veganoutreach.org/subs/) for everything from milk and ice cream to hamburgers and cold cuts coming to market every year.

Check out the charities noted above for more information and ideas on ways to help. Additionally, learn about becoming a [reducetarian \(https://reducetarian.org/\)](https://reducetarian.org/) with a diet that includes fewer animal products.

Isn't this just the natural order?

We often hear: "it's the natural order of things" or "just what god intended." The fact that something is natural does not automatically make it good. Disease and murder are natural. Treating animals humanely is no more an affront to nature than curing disease or criminalizing murder.

Nature can be cruel; industrializing that cruelty is wrong.

How many animals are killed for food in the US each year?

The United States Department of Agriculture reports that 9.76 billion land animals were slaughtered [in 2020 \(https://www.ers.usda.gov/data-products/livestock-meat-domestic-data/livestock-meat-domestic-data/#Livestock%20and%20poultry%20slaughter\)](https://www.ers.usda.gov/data-products/livestock-meat-domestic-data/livestock-meat-domestic-data/#Livestock%20and%20poultry%20slaughter):

- Chickens: 9,346,660,000
- Turkeys: 223,003,000
- Cattle (incl. calves): 33,242,000
- Pigs: 131,563,000
- Ducks: 22,484,000
- Sheep (incl. lambs): 2,225,000

Accounting for U.S. animal meat imports and exports², 8.2 billion land animals were killed to support the U.S. food supply:

- Chickens: 7,835,037,000
- Turkeys: 201,638,000
- Cattle (incl. calves): 33,714,000
- Pigs: 101,916,000
- Ducks: 22,484,000
- Sheep (incl. lambs): 6,768,000

Adjusting for pre-slaughter farmed animal mortality rates³, industrial farming claimed the lives of **8.53 billion land animals** in 2020 to support the U.S. food supply:

- Chickens: 8,127,632,000
- Turkeys: 214,509,000
- Cattle (incl. calves): 36,164,000
- Pigs: 124,061,000
- Ducks: 23,275,000
- Sheep (incl. lambs): 7,499,000

Aquatic animal deaths are challenging to calculate since these lives are measured in tons. A very thorough [analysis](http://www.countinganimals.com/how-many-animals-does-a-vegetarian-save/) (<http://www.countinganimals.com/how-many-animals-does-a-vegetarian-save/>), completed by Counting Animals estimated that 3.8 billion finned fish and 43.1 billion shellfish were killed to support the U.S. food supply in 2013. Total U.S. fish landings remained flat at these levels at least through 2018.

Taken together, more than **55 billion** land and sea animals die annually to support the U.S. food supply. Adding in bycatch (sea creatures caught and discarded--injured or dead) and feed fish, the total number jumps substantially (<http://www.countinganimals.com/the-fish-we-kill-to-feed-the-fish-we-eat/>).

To put this in perspective, during World War II--the deadliest conflict in human history--more than 60 million people were killed over 6 years. The same number of animals die in support of the American food supply every ten hours.

How many animals die for food in the United States every second?

Land animals only (USDA 2020 slaughter + imports - exports + pre-slaughter deaths)⁴:

- Every year: 8,533,141,000
- Every day: 23,378,000
- Every hour: 974,100
- Every minute: 16,234
- Every second: 271

Inclusive of land and aquatic animals:

- Every year: 55,429,141,000
- Every day: 151,888,000
- Every hour: 6,328,000
- Every minute: 105,480
- Every second: 1,758

MORE TO SEE

INFORMATION

[Animal Charity Evaluators](https://animalcharityevaluators.org/charity-reviews/all-charity-reviews/) (<https://animalcharityevaluators.org/charity-reviews/all-charity-reviews/>).

[Animal Cognition](https://www.animalcognition.org/) (<https://www.animalcognition.org/>).

[Animal Welfare Institute](https://awionline.org) (<https://awionline.org>).

[Factory Farming Awareness](https://www.ffacoalition.org) (<https://www.ffacoalition.org>).

[Fish Feel](https://fishfeel.org/) (<https://fishfeel.org/>).

[Freedom for Animals](https://www.freedomforanimals.org.uk/) (<https://www.freedomforanimals.org.uk/>). (UK)

[Humane Facts](http://humanefacts.org/) (<http://humanefacts.org/>).

[Humane Slaughter Association](https://www.hsa.org.uk) (<https://www.hsa.org.uk>). (UK)

[My Dream for Animals](https://www.mydreamforanimals.com) (<https://www.mydreamforanimals.com>).

[Sentient Media](https://sentientmedia.org) (<https://sentientmedia.org>).

[Viva!](https://www.viva.org.uk) (<https://www.viva.org.uk>). (UK)

ADVOCACY

[Animal Aid](https://www.animalaid.org.uk/) (<https://www.animalaid.org.uk/>). (UK)

[Animal Equality](http://animalequality.net/) (<http://animalequality.net/>).

[Animal Justice](https://www.animaljustice.ca/) (<https://www.animaljustice.ca/>). (CA)

[AnimalKIND](https://animalkind.org.au/) (<https://animalkind.org.au/>). (AU)

[Animal Liberaition](https://www.animal-lib.org.au) (<https://www.animal-lib.org.au>). (AU)

[Animals Australia](https://www.animalsaustralia.org/) (<https://www.animalsaustralia.org/>). (AU)

[Compassion In World Farming](https://www.ciwf.com/) (<https://www.ciwf.com/>).

[Farm Animal Rights](https://www.farmusa.org) (<https://www.farmusa.org>).

[The Humane League](https://thehumaneleague.org/) (<https://thehumaneleague.org/>). (US (<https://thehumaneleague.org/>), UK (<https://thehumaneleague.org.uk/>))

[Humane Society](https://www.humanesociety.org/issues/campaigns/factory_farming/) (https://www.humanesociety.org/issues/campaigns/factory_farming/).

[Mercy For Animals](https://mercyforanimals.com/) (<https://mercyforanimals.com/>).

[PETA](https://www.peta.org/issues/animals-used-for-food/factory-farming/) (<https://www.peta.org/issues/animals-used-for-food/factory-farming/>).

[RSPCA](https://www.rspca.org.au/) (<https://www.rspca.org.au/>). (AU)

[RSPCA](https://www.rspca.org.uk/adviceandwelfare/farm) (<https://www.rspca.org.uk/adviceandwelfare/farm>). (UK)

[Voiceless](https://www.voiceless.org.au/) (<https://www.voiceless.org.au/>). (AU)

NEWS

[All Creatures](https://www.all-creatures.org/) (<https://www.all-creatures.org/>).

[The Dodo](https://www.thedodo.com/) (<https://www.thedodo.com/>).

[One Green Planet](https://www.onegreenplanet.org/) (<https://www.onegreenplanet.org/>).

[Plant Based News](https://www.plantbasednews.org/) (<https://www.plantbasednews.org/>).

DATA

[USDA Economic Research Service](https://www.ers.usda.gov/) (<https://www.ers.usda.gov/>).

[Counting Animals](https://www.countinganimals.com/) (<https://www.countinganimals.com/>).

[Fishcount](https://fishcount.co.uk/) (<https://fishcount.co.uk/>).

[UN FAO Statistics](https://www.fao.org/faostat/en/#home) (<https://www.fao.org/faostat/en/#home>).

[Reducing Suffering](https://reducing-suffering.org/) (<https://reducing-suffering.org/>).

[World Animal Protection](https://www.worldanimalprotection.org/) (<https://www.worldanimalprotection.org/>).

VEGAN

[A Well-Fed World](https://awfw.org) (<https://awfw.org>).

[Good Food Institute](https://www.gfi.org/) (<https://www.gfi.org/>).

[The Green Plate](https://thegreenplate.com/) (<https://thegreenplate.com/>).

[Love Veg](https://www.loveveg.com/) (<https://www.loveveg.com/>).

[Veganuary](https://veganuary.com) (<https://veganuary.com>).

[Vegan4Life \(https://www.vegan4life.org.au/\)](https://www.vegan4life.org.au/). (AU)

SANCTUARY

[Edgar's Mission \(https://www.edgarsmission.org.au/\)](https://www.edgarsmission.org.au/). (AU)

[Farm Sanctuary \(https://www.farmsanctuary.org/learn/factory-farming/\)](https://www.farmsanctuary.org/learn/factory-farming/).

ABOUT

Animal Clock was created to bring attention to the incredible number of animals currently suffering on factory farms.

Logo: [AI \(/img/logos/animal-clock-logo.ai\)](#), [PNG \(/img/logos/animal-clock-logo.png\)](#). (icon only: [AI \(/img/logos/animal-clock-icon.ai\)](#), [PNG \(/img/logos/animal-clock-icon-lg.png\)](#))

CONTACT

Email: [contact@animalclock\[DOT\]org](mailto:contact@animalclock[DOT]org)

[🐦 @animal_clock \(https://twitter.com/animal_clock\)](https://twitter.com/animal_clock).

DATA SOURCES

- U.S. Land Animal Slaughter (2020):
[Livestock Slaughter: 2020 Summary \(Apr 2021\) \(https://www.nass.usda.gov/Publications/Todays_Reports/reports/lsan0421.pdf\)](https://www.nass.usda.gov/Publications/Todays_Reports/reports/lsan0421.pdf)
USDA National Agricultural Statistics Service
[Poultry Slaughter: 2020 Summary \(Feb 2021\) \(https://downloads.usda.library.cornell.edu/usda-esmis/files/pg15bd88s/f1882d39g/j6731z19s/pslaan21.pdf\)](https://downloads.usda.library.cornell.edu/usda-esmis/files/pg15bd88s/f1882d39g/j6731z19s/pslaan21.pdf)
USDA National Agricultural Statistics Service
- International Trade Data (2020):
[Livestock and Meat International Trade Data \(Meat Data\) \(https://www.ers.usda.gov/data-products/livestock-and-meat-international-trade-data/\)](https://www.ers.usda.gov/data-products/livestock-and-meat-international-trade-data/)
USDA Economic Research Service
- Farmed Animal Mortality Rates:
[Animal Welfare Data \(multiple years\) \(https://www.aphis.usda.gov/aphis/ourfocus/animalwelfare\)](https://www.aphis.usda.gov/aphis/ourfocus/animalwelfare)
Animal and Plant Health Inspection Service
- Fish and Crustacean Estimates (2013):
[How Many Animals Does a Vegetarian Save \(Table 4\) \(http://www.countinganimals.com/how-many-animals-does-a-vegetarian-save/\)](http://www.countinganimals.com/how-many-animals-does-a-vegetarian-save/)
Counting Animals
[Worse Things Happen at Sea \(2010\) \(http://fishcount.org.uk/publications\)](http://fishcount.org.uk/publications) (fish weights)
FishCount

NOTES

- ¹ Fish and shellfish counts do not include ~23 billion animals killed as bycatch (sea creatures unintentionally caught and released) nor ~68 billion feed fish (small fish fed to fish raised for human consumption) based on median [estimates \(http://www.countinganimals.com/how-many-animals-does-a-vegetarian-save/\)](http://www.countinganimals.com/how-many-animals-does-a-vegetarian-save/) by Counting Animals.
- ² Import and export estimates are based on USDA ERS meat trade data (measured by carcass weight). To estimate the corresponding animal counts, we use carcass weights calculated from domestic production data.
- ³ Pre-slaughter mortality rates reflect the percentage of livestock from live birth that do not survive to slaughter. Since available APHIS data is a decade old, we assume a 15% reduction in published mortality rates for all animals except poultry where more recent data is available. Poultry data excludes first day culling as this practice will be largely eliminated in U.S. next year through the use of in-ovo sexing.
- ⁴ Numbers are not adjusted for frozen product stocks (meat used from prior year or preserved for the following year).

INTERNATIONAL CLOCKS

Animal Clock is currently available in Australia, Canada, the United Kingdom, and the United States.

If you work with an established animal welfare organization and would like to partner with us to launch a clock in your country, please contact us.

- [Australia \(/au/\)](#).
- [Canada \(/ca/\)](#).
- [United Kingdom \(/uk/\)](#).
- [United States \(/\)](#).

SHARE



 (https w .com/intent/tweet?

(<http://www.huffpost.com/2012/01/22/industrial-factory-farmed-animals+are+bred+for+slaughter+on+factory>)

u=http://euid.hisupplier.com/Trade%20Buy%20Able%20Deal%20Status/bodyS=1%20Supply%20

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